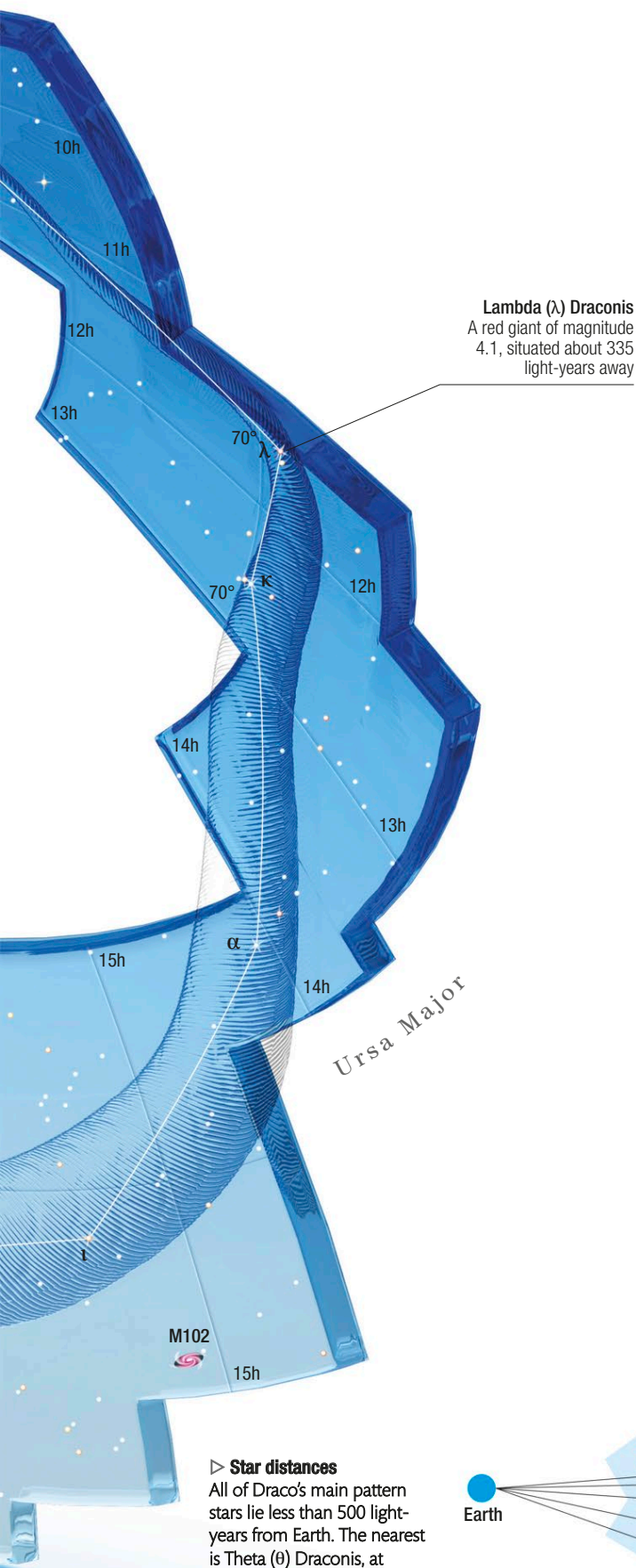


● **Etamin**
250 Suns

● **Thuban**
255 Suns

● **Rastaban**
905 Suns



Lambda (λ) Draconis
A red giant of magnitude 4.1, situated about 335 light-years away



△ **UGC 10214**
Commonly called the Tadpole Galaxy, this unusually shaped galaxy has a streamer of stars and gas some 280,000 light-years long stretching out behind it. The long tail was pulled out by the gravitational force of a smaller passing galaxy, just visible through the foreground spiral arms at the upper left.

▽ **NGC 6543**
This planetary nebula consists of at least 11 shells of gas and dust that are thought to have been ejected from the central star in a series of pulses at 1,500-year intervals. The shells have created a pattern resembling a cat's eye, hence the nebula's popular name: the Cat's Eye Nebula.



KEY DATA

Size ranking 8
Brightest stars Etamin (γ) 2.2, Eta (η) 2.7
Genitive Draconis
Abbreviation Dra
Highest in sky at 10pm April–August
Fully visible 90°N–4°S



CHART 1

MAIN STARS

Thuban Alpha (α) Draconis
Blue-white giant
☼ 3.7 ↔ 303 light-years

Rastaban Beta (β) Draconis
Yellow supergiant
☼ 2.8 ↔ 380 light-years

Etamin Gamma (γ) Draconis
Orange giant, also known as Eltanin
☼ 2.2 ↔ 154 light-years

Delta (δ) Draconis
Yellow giant
☼ 3.1 ↔ 97 light-years

Zeta (ζ) Draconis
Blue-white giant
☼ 3.2 ↔ 330 light-years

Eta (η) Draconis
Yellow giant
☼ 2.7 ↔ 92 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

NGC 6503
Spiral galaxy

NGC 6543 (Cat's Eye Nebula)
Planetary nebula

NGC 6621 and NGC 6622
Interacting galaxies

NGC 6786
Spiral galaxy

UGC 10214 (Tadpole Galaxy)
Disrupted spiral galaxy

▷ **Star distances**
All of Draco's main pattern stars lie less than 500 light-years from Earth. The nearest is Theta (θ) Draconis, at 69 light-years away. The farthest is Kappa (κ) Draconis, at a distance of 500 light-years. The brightest pattern star, Etamin (γ Draconis) is relatively close, at 154 light-years away.

